
Update

14 messages

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Tue, Aug 6, 2019 at 1:54 PM

To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>, Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Hi both

I searched the Halifax PoW registers to no avail - I have put the photos in a folder marked 'irrelevant', just to show the volumes I searched, with sample pages - I photographed all the Dutch Pows, given Todd's remark. No need to spend time looking at these, but I wanted to save them safely in case my theory (see below) proves unfounded.

I managed to trace Leven from the 7th battalion into the 3rd, until his discharge in 1818. He now appears as 'Louis Demel(l)'

In the June - Sep 1817 payroll of the 3rd I've photographed the covers and also the top of the page on which he appears so that you can see the headings (img 626) . He's on the next page (627). He's in Company 10, and voucher 6 refers - he's annotated 'from the 7th Bttn' so I'm pretty sure this is our Leven.

Voucher 6 refers to the order transferring men from the 7th to the 3rd Bttn.

I photographed his entry for the following quarters, where he has no particular annotation until we get to June- Sep 1818 when his name is struck through (you'll find him at #130) and he is annotated 'discharged' as of 25th July, and under 'whither' it says 'in this country'. Voucher 11 refers to 'men discharged in this country'.

I went back to WO12/7088 to try to work out some more details, without much success, apart from the lightbulb moment that it looked as though Leven could well have been a PoW in Europe, rather than at Halifax. The previous quarter to the one where Leven first appears shows a huge number of recruits - Leven is not listed, but a Casimir Demoll who subsequently appears in the paylists as PoW is listed. It looks as though the regiment transferred to Halifax from Guernsey some time during the period Sep 1813 - Dec 1813. I took a few photos of this quarter, but won't confuse the issue by putting them in Dropbox.

I took a closer look at Leven's first entry in the Dec 1813 - Mar 1814 quarter, and saw he had a reference to voucher 1, which says 'original report for 120 men subsisted to 12 December 1813 and who arrived at Head Quarters 29 December'. (img 653 shows headings for this page; 654 has Leven's entry). I didn't know quite what to make of this, but it suggested that Leven might have been in the regiment prior to 12 December.

I then did a search for Leven in PoW records on www.findmypast, without limiting it to Halifax, and got very excited when I found Leven Demangler, who had been on board a prison ship in Portsmouth, and discharged into the 7th Btn of the 60th Foot. (see attached)..

However, on reviewing the photos of Leven's entry (654) I saw that Leven Demangler is also listed - bang goes another theory.

However, I now suspect that Leven was a PoW in Europe rather than Halifax (makes a lot more sense when you come to think about it!). Having now discounted Leven Demangler, I'll have to spend more time searching European PoWs using every different spelling variation of forename / surname I can think of.

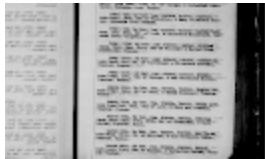
I've spent 4 hours so far - are you happy for me to do a couple more, even though I might draw a blank?

By the way, I found a transcription of the Chester parish registers on www.familysearch, and am attaching the relevant pages for Leven's 2nd marriage and Peter Levi's baptism - thought you'd be interested to see the whole page. The first marriage isn't listed (see the 1821 entries) presumably because it was performed by the Baptist minister, ie not in St Stephen's church.

4 attachments



**GBM_POW-GALLIP_15-0273_GB-SRY_ADM-103-NAVY-BOARD-AND-
PREDECESSORS-P-386-CA-1755-1831_00008.jpg**
1586K



1833 chester bapt.png
841K



1826 Chester marriages.png
895K



1821 chester marriages.png
866K

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
Cc: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Tue, Aug 6, 2019 at 4:12 PM

Thank you, Ruth!

Great to get confirmation of the transfer to the 3rd Battalion and then ultimately of Leven's discharge in 1818.

Walking through some of the data...

Leven's first appearance in the lists (and our first known record of him!) is in the quarter logged from 25 Dec 1813 to 24 Mar 1814.

Next to Leven's name, the 'From' column under 'period of payment' has the number '16' in it. The 'To' Column has '24' and the amount paid is '99 days'. There are 99 days between Dec 16, 1813 and March 24, 1814, so that adds up.

Since the ledger is listed as covering only 25 Dec to 24 Mar, most men serving that full period would be owed only 90 days pay unless they were among the Voucher 1. group: 'Original Report for 120 Men subsisted to 15th Decemb 1813 and who arrived at Head Quarters 29th Decemb.'

The men in the Voucher 1 group shown in the photographed entry all seem to have 99 days pay and also all seem to have the 'as no 5' entry. Was there any clue what that note could mean?

I gather 'subsisted' means 'already paid through' Dec 15th. Could this mean Dec 16th to the 29th, when they arrived at Head Quarters, was travel time from the previous post to Halifax? Does 14 days travel time provide a clue? Google suggests sailing time across the Atlantic in the early 1800s was ~6 weeks?

Do you think Leven could have been among the men transferred to Halifax from Guernsey between Sep and Dec 1813? Is that the new potential connection with Europe? You refer to the men transferred as a regiment. Could that include POWs? I suppose it could if they had already volunteered!

Casimir Demoll appears in later entries in addition to Leven ruling him out as a suspect?

The Leven Demangler theory is interesting in part because I remember Walter Sr. saying the family name was once "Demblahblah..." I'm not sure if he was just noting all the minor mutations the name has undergone, but I had the

impression the name was shortened at some time from something longer and more complex. It's also interesting that Demangler looks like he's listed as 'Lou' in the playlist and Leven is later listed as 'Louis'. But they are listed together in quarters so, yes, bang.

Thank you for the Chester parish registers and all your time, Ruth. Please feel free to send an invoice. A couple more hours to try to find a record of Leven among records of European POWs would be fine. I'm actually pretty optimistic that that is where this thread seems to lead. Are the POW records fully digitized and/or available at TNA? And failing that, we'll have to assess what other threads remain that we might follow!

Todd

[Quoted text hidden]

wdemelle . <wdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>

Tue, Aug 6, 2019 at 5:05 PM

Thank you, Ruth. This is all very intriguing. Quite a puzzle to be sure!

I would not necessarily put too much stock in Grampy's knowledge of his family history, Todd. It is true that there was an awareness that the name spelling differed quite a bit but in my conversations with both my grandfather (Double grampy) and my father recollections or stories never veered far from the basic letters "d,i,e,m,l". Double Grampa used to say his family had spelled it "Dimmell" ("D - i - double m - e - double l") I can hear him now, believe it or not. Anyway, other than errors in transcription or handwriting (you run across those a lot in genealogy searching) I think we are pretty much on track. Interestingly when I went to Nova Scotia in search of kin I wrote about 25 people whose last name was spelled DeMille or something close to that. Only a few responded to me because we spell our name with all e's (DeMelle). That change did take place, according to Double Grampa, when they emigrated to the U.S. Never got a good explanation of why. Cousins who also lived in Mass. (mostly in Framingham!) spelled the name DeMille. And all of the relatives I actually did meet did the same.

Enough from now. I am supposed to be packing!

Thanks, all, for this good work and for your interest in uncovering what we can of DeMelle/DeMille family history.

Walter

I am about to leave Lakeville and will be going away for several weeks. I will try to take with me some of my notes but I won't have room for all of it.

[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 7, 2019 at 3:13 AM

Hi both

Thank you for your feedback, and I wish you a good trip, W

Todd - Casimir and Leven are definitely 2 separate people, as are Leven and Demangler. I identified Leven Demangler on Findmypast (FMP) after I got home and it was pure chance that I had him in the same photo as Leven Demel. I note that he is not annotated 'vol from pris of war', and he is also checked in the column 'entitled to higher pay for length of service 7 years' which doesn't seem right. I'll have yet another look at this playlist next time I'm at TNA. No, I didn't find any explanation of 'note 5' I'm afraid.

I've searched TNA's catalogue, and the only PoW register specifically dealing with German PoWs is on FMP, and yields no suspects (apart from Demangler).

I also searched for Dutch PoWs, and there are several registers which might be worth searching, but they have not been digitised, so might take a while to search through. I can do this on Thursday - it might take a little longer than 2 hours but I'll limit it to 3 if possible - is this OK? If you think this is too long a shot, let me know.

My invoice for 4 hours is attached and I'll raise a Paypal request.

Best regards

Ruth

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tna190802Todd DeMelle.odt
17K

Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 7, 2019 at 7:48 AM

Todd,
I cannot open this zip file. Can you? How do I do it?

Walter DeMelle
POB 1453
Lakeville, CT 06039

Begin forwarded message:

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tna190802Todd DeMelle.odt
17K

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 7, 2019 at 12:03 PM

Hi both

Correction: the main Dutch PoW registers, from the Prison Ship Genereux HAVE been digitised, but Leven does not appear to be there. There is one other register that has not been digitised that I can look at, but it occurs to me that maybe not all of the records have survived, also looking at some of the records I saw a reference to the 'Brave' prison ship, but can find no records for prisoners on this ship.

More in hope than expectation, I can take a look at the registers that don't appear to be digitised, and keep within the 2 hours.

My best
Ruth

PS many thanks for the payment Todd

[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 7, 2019 at 12:15 PM

Hi both

Just one final thought - I checked the KGL 7th line btn, as per Todd's original request, for 1814. I wonder whether it might be an idea to have a look at the 1813 playlists just in case Leven went to the 60th via the KGL? (clutching at straws here admittedly...)

Ruth
[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 7, 2019 at 10:57 PM

To: Walter DeMelle <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Hi Skip,

It's not a zip file. It's .odt format... which I'm not particularly familiar with, but am able to open. It's just an invoice anyway!

I've been enjoying this little adventure with Ruth. It would be a shame if it bore no fruit to follow up on! Fingers are still crossed. I hope all's well. Safe travels!

[Quoted text hidden]

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
Cc: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 7, 2019 at 11:32 PM

Thank you again, Ruth,
I consider ruling things out progress!

Would you say we have effectively ruled out that Leven was a POW in Halifax?

The POW register dealing with German POWs in TNA and on FMP that you mention is for prisoners in Europe? Does it specify which depots it covers?

I came across this article searching online which I found interesting for context and perhaps clues...

The Release of Prisoners of War from Britain in 1813 and 1814 <https://www.cairn.info/revue-napoleonica-la-revue-2014-3-page-118.htm#>

Here are some notable excerpts...

The decisive defeat of Napoleon at the Battle of Leipzig in 1813 convinced many of his German allies to throw in their lot with the Coalition forces.

With the large numbers of Germans and Italians in the prison depots who were being conscripted into the forces arrayed against Napoleon, this was seen as potentially a serious problem.

There were already such nationalities being held at Valleyfield, so by August 1812 there were at least 641 Italians and 588 Germans collected at the depot.

The only choice these men were given was that of which force they could join. From Valleyfield they enlisted into the King's German Legion, the 1st Dutch Regiment and most of the Italians into the army of the King of Sardinia.

Some of the specific British Prison Depots mentioned in the article include: Dartmoor, Plymouth, Stapleton, Norman Cross, Chatham, Portchester, Portsmouth, Valleyfield, Perth

Would specific depots perhaps have registries of prisoners somewhere that can be searched?

I think looking at the 1813 KGL records is worth a shot! With so few straws left, I don't mind a little grasping. One more try! If it's 4 more hours to be exhaustive, so be it. He has to have been a POW somewhere!

I imagine this is familiar to you, but just to be thorough, I came across TNA guidelines for searching for POWs up to 1855 from <http://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/help-with-your-research/research-guides/prisoners-of-war-british-hands/#6-prisoners-of-war-up-to-1855>

There is no general index to prisoners, so searching for individuals may be hard.

Search our catalogue within ADM 97, ADM 105 and ADM 103 and refine by date.

You can find:

- *lists of prisoners, usually arranged by nationality or by place of confinement or parole, in ADM 103: these often include circumstances of their capture and eventual disposal – some of these are available on Findmypast (£)*
- *prisoners' petitions in ADM 97*
- *lists of PoW exchanges, for example WO 40/2 and WO 1/905-16*
- *circumstances of capture and incarceration in WO 1 and WO 4*

An alphabetical list of American prisoners compiled by the University of Virginia is available at The National Archives and supplements a general register of American prisoners (1813) in ADM 6/417. Please note, ADM 6/417 is available on Findmypast (£).

Browse lists of enemy prisoners on parole in Britain in HO 28. This is not indexed.

Fingers crossed,
Todd

[Quoted text hidden]

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Thu, Aug 8, 2019 at 4:15 AM

Thanks, Todd.

To answer your questions - I can't say 100% we've ruled out Leven being a PoW at Halifax, but on the balance of probability I think he was probably shipped over from England.
The German PoWs were on board the prison ship St Antoine - I think she was at Portsmouth, but certainly in the UK

The Paul Chamberlain article is a great find, and one I hadn't come across before. I read it with interest, especially as regard the PoWs 'volunteering' for British regiments etc.

I am familiar with TNA's research guide on PoWs, and have used it to direct my search. As is the way with these things, every time you go back to the catalogue it seems to throw up different things, and so I did another search (previously I was just looking for German or Dutch PoWs). The registers are organised by location (often prison ship). The only prison registers mentioned for Valleyfield say they are for 'nationality French' - and it's on FMP,. I looked on FMP and there are 12,713 for Valleyfield, most of them French, but I spotted at least one with a German name who was discharged into the 60th (see attached - he's at the bottom of the page)

My new strategy for searching TNA's catalogue has been to search on 'prisoner of war' with a date range 1810 - 1813. I have used the 'advanced search' to look for 'dutch', 'various' and 'german' and exclude 'deaths' and 'exchanged'. This gives 61 results. I then refined it to '1813', giving a more manageable 31. Checking through each of these I could exclude any which direct you to 'findmypast', resulting in a list of the following:
ADM/103/8, /11, /86, /117, /163, /216, /218, /420, /566.

The flaw in this of course is that the nationalities might have been incorrectly classified in the catalogue, as per Valleyfield - but I clearly wouldn't have the time to search the 100 or so additional registers which include French prisoners - they aren't indexed so even the registers I've identified might prove impossible.

If Leven was sent to Dartmoor or some other conventional prison (ie not a prison ship) these records appear to have been put on FMP.

By the way, on the principle of 4 eyes being better than 2, you might want to try searching on FMP yourself - I believe you can get a 'free trial' for a period of one or two weeks. Of course we're at the mercy of the transcribers and clearly there are many variants of Leven's first and second names to consider, so he could be lurking there somewhere in disguise!

I'll look at the KGL playlist and also the 6th Btn of the 60th - I've been scouring online for any history of the 60th, and it seems that the 7th Btn was formed in Sep 1813 specifically for the American war. One resource says it was formed at Gibraltar; this does not square with the muster books I've seen so far which suggest that the regiment was at Sandown (isle of wight) earlier in 1813, which is where apparently the 6th btn was - so maybe that was the 'headquarters'. I live in hope.

I'll then move on to working through the PoW registers identified above.

Best regards
Ruth

[Quoted text hidden]



GBM_POW-GALLIP_101506018_00196.jpg
1307K

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
Cc: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Fri, Aug 9, 2019 at 6:05 AM

I have now spent a further 4+ hours, but I'm afraid the only thing I can tell you for sure is that Leven was NOT a PoW in Halifax, but was shipped over from England.

I went back yet again to the wo12/7088 payroll and studied the preceding quarters yet again. I noted that on first formation, most if not all of the recruits had been enlisted from PoWs at Portsmouth. They are annotated 'Enlisted by Captain Marshal 1st Veteran Btn KGLegion from Prisoners of War at Portsmouth Commence subsistence from the dates set opposite their respective names'.

I photographed almost all of this quarter and the following quarter when there were many more recruits, but I could not see Leven amongst them. I have also done some searches on Findmypast for names listed, including other names listed as 'vol from prisoner of war' in Leven's payroll, to no avail.

I had another look at the quarter with Leven's first entry, and think that 'as no 5' refers to a comment on the first page 'ship rations to 4 Mar', though given Leven was paid in the quarter to 24 Mar not sure I can make sense of it.

However, I spotted something I should have noticed earlier on the March - May quarter - the Paymaster's affidavit says that the Btn was on board ship for the whole period. Thus Leven was definitely a PoW in England before arriving in Halifax.

I checked the 6th Btn 60th which was in Jamaica, and also the Depot Btn of the KGL in Bexhill (England) to no avail. I searched various PoW registers which have not been digitised, but it really is like looking for a needle in a haystack. Some of them which had been catalogued as 'Nationality various' turned out to be 99% French, and the Genereuse Prison ship catalogued as Dutch was definitely French. I have put images of the front page or cover of the files I searched for the record (no need to look at these in detail).

I think we really have reached the end of what can sensibly be done now, unless you spot anything in the paylists you want me to follow up. All I can suggest is that in a few years' time you check back in with FMP, in the hope that further registers have been digitised and Leven appears.

I'll only invoice you for 3 hours, unless there's anything else, to reflect the time wasted on the Halifax PoW red herring.

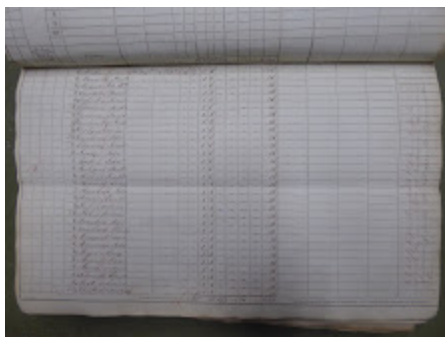
I've put the new photos in Dropbox.

Best regards

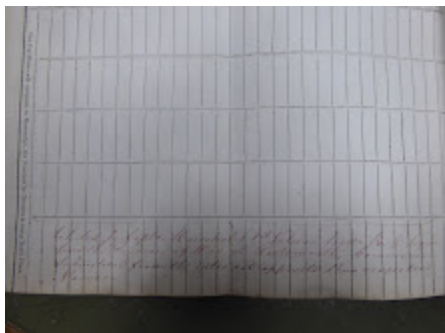
Ruth

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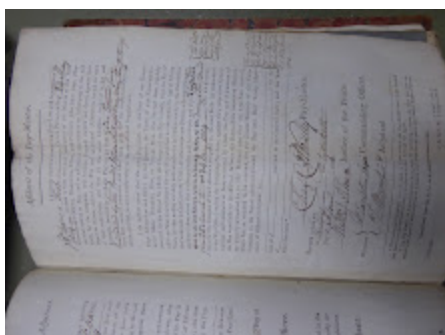
3 attachments



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P1070661.JPG
2636K



P1070704.JPG
2994K

Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>
To: Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
Cc: "wdemelle ." <wdemelle@gmail.com>

Sun, Aug 11, 2019 at 11:16 AM

Thank you for your expertise, guidance and work, Ruth!

Levi is proving to be an elusive man to track down, but we've learned quite a bit about his fascinating circumstances.

I plan to sit down with all our discoveries showing where he was and where he wasn't, chart them in a timeline and see if it provides some ideas for further investigation.

I'll let you know what comes of it. In the meantime, please send your last invoice.

Thank you again for your help with our investigation!

Sincerely,
Todd

Sent from my iPhone
[Quoted text hidden]

<P1070660.JPG>

<P1070661.JPG>

<P1070704.JPG>

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 12, 2019 at 3:29 AM

Many thanks Todd.

My invoice is attached and I'll raise a Paypal request.

My best
Ruth
[Quoted text hidden]



tna190803Todd DeMelle.odt
17K

Ruth Bloom <ruthpbloom@gmail.com>
To: Todd DeMelle <tdemelle@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 12, 2019 at 11:50 AM

Many thanks for the super-fast payment!

Ruth
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